Electric Dehorner



Category: **Animal Husbandry & Dairy** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 3 labs

Covers these lab items: Electric dehorner

What it is used for

An electric dehorner uses controlled heat to destroy horn-producing tissue in young livestock when the procedure is approved and performed by a trained professional. Correct animal assessment, pain management, temperature control, and aftercare are essential to reduce burns, infection, and animal distress.

Main parts

- Heating tip transfers heat to the treatment area.
- Heating element produces the required heat.
- Handle provides a controlled grip.
- Power cable connects the tool to its supply.
- Power switch controls heating where fitted.
- Temperature control or indicator helps monitor heat where available.
- Protective stand holds the hot tool between uses.
- Power supply or battery powers the model.

Before you start

1. Only trained and legally authorised animal-care personnel should perform dehorning.
2. Confirm the animal's age, health, suitability, and applicable veterinary requirements before treatment.
3. Use an approved pain-management plan and follow veterinary guidance for the species and age.
4. Inspect the heating tip, handle, cable, plug, controls, and protective stand for damage.
5. Prepare appropriate animal restraint, clean equipment, and a safe, ventilated work area.
6. Check the tool's instructions for warm-up time and approved operating temperature.
7. Keep flammable materials away and prepare suitable burn first-aid supplies.

How to use

1. Restrain the animal using an approved method that minimises stress and sudden movement.
2. Confirm the correct treatment site and procedure with the responsible veterinary professional.
3. Apply the prescribed pain-management and hygiene measures before using the tool.
4. Place the dehorner on its protective stand and warm it up according to the manual.
5. Check that the tool has reached the specified operating condition using its indicator or approved method.
6. Apply the heating tip only according to the approved veterinary technique and equipment instructions.

7. Avoid unnecessary contact with surrounding skin and follow the prescribed application duration.
8. Remove the tool carefully and place it back on the protective stand.
9. Observe the animal for excessive bleeding, burns, distress, or other complications and seek veterinary help when needed.
10. Provide aftercare and follow-up monitoring according to the veterinary plan.
11. Switch off, unplug where applicable, and allow the tool to cool completely before cleaning or storage.
12. Record the treatment date, animal identification, operator, and observations.

⚠ Safety

- Never use an electric dehorner without appropriate training and authorisation.
- The heating tip can cause severe burns; never touch it or leave it on an unsuitable surface.
- Do not exceed the approved temperature or application duration.
- Use secure animal restraint and keep hands away from the hot tip and sudden movement zones.
- Do not use damaged cables, plugs, or temperature controls.
- Follow animal-welfare requirements, pain-management guidance, and veterinary aftercare instructions.

Care & storage

- After the tool has cooled completely, remove residue using the approved cleaning method.
- Inspect the heating tip, handle, cable, plug, and controls before and after use.
- Keep the tool dry and store it in a protected location away from combustible materials.
- Arrange authorised servicing if heating becomes uneven or temperature control is unreliable.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Using the tool without checking animal suitability or the veterinary plan.
- Applying excessive heat or holding the tip in place too long.
- Leaving the hot dehorner unattended or without its protective stand.
- Ignoring signs of burns, infection, or distress after treatment.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.